Zikun Ye

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Employment

Michael G. Foster School of Business

University of Washington, Seattle, Washington

Assistant Professor of Marketing — 2023–Present

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Illinois — 2018–2023

Ph.D., Operations Research

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, China — 2014–2018

B.S., Industrial Engineering and Mathematics (Summa cum laude)

Research Interest

Large Language Models; Digital Marketplace; Quantitative Marketing; Optimization; Causal Inference; Field Experiment; Machine Learning.

Publications

† Authors listed alphabetically. * Student advised.

Zikun Ye, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Fair Document Valuation in LLM Summaries via Shapley Values. ***Management Science***, forthcoming, 2026. [Link]

Shuai Li*, **Zikun Ye**, Xin Chen, Weijun Xie. Joint Assortment Optimization and Discrete Marketing Mix Allocation. ***Manufacturing & Service Operations Management***, 2026. [Link]

Zikun Ye, Zhiqi Zhang, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang. Deep-Learning-Based Causal Inference for Large-Scale Combinatorial Experiments: Theory and Empirical Evidence. ***Management Science***, 2026, 72(7). [Link]

- Accepted at *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation* (EC'23)
- First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award, 2023
- Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award, 2023

Zikun Ye, Hema Yoganarasimhan, Yufeng Zheng. LOLA: LLM-Assisted Online Learning Algorithm for Content Experiments. ***Marketing Science***, 2025, 44(5). [Link]

Xin Chen, Niao He, Yifan Hu, **Zikun Ye**†. Efficient Algorithms for a Class of Stochastic Hidden Convex Optimization and Its Applications in Network Revenue Management. ***Operations Research***, 2025, 73(2). [Link]

Zikun Ye, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang, Xin Chen. Cold Start to Improve Market Thickness on Online Advertising Platforms: Data-Driven Algorithms and Field Experiments. ***Management Science***, 2023, 69(7). [Link]

- Finalist, INFORMS RMP Section Jeff McGill Best Student Paper, 2020
- Follow-up work with Walmart Global Tech: Seller-side Outcome Fairness in Online Marketplaces. Short paper presented at the *NeurIPS 2023 Workshop on Algorithmic Fairness through the Lens of Time*. [Link]

Working Papers

Zikun Ye, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Rectification Difficulty and Optimal Sample Allocation in LLM-Augmented Surveys, *major revision in Management Science.* [Link]

- Short version accepted for presentation at the *NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on ML×OR*

Zikun Ye, Jinglong Zhao, Lei Wang*. Fine-Tune, Then Rectify, *under review in Management Science.* [Link]

- Short version accepted for presentation at the *NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on ML×OR*

Zikun Ye, Jiameng Lyu, Rui Tao. Allocating Human Oversight in AI-Enabled Analytics, *major revision in Production and Operations Management.* [Link]

Academic Talks

NeurIPS Workshop on ML×OR	2026
INFORMS Annual Meeting	2026
UW-UBC Marketing Camp	2026
Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics, Columbia Business School	2025
ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2025
Marketing Junior Faculty Forum, Washington University in St. Louis	2025
MIT Data Science Lab	2025
AI in Management (AIM) Conference	2025
AI and Marketing Conference, Stanford GSB (discussant)	2025
Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy (discussant)	2025
MarkTech Conference, Columbia Business School	2024
Quantitative Marketing and Economics (QME) Conference, Stanford GSB	2024
China-India Insight Program, Hong Kong	2024
Washington University in St. Louis	2024
Shanghai Jiao Tong University	2024
UW-UBC Marketing Camp	2024
ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2024
ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC)	2023
INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing (RMP) Conference	2023
MSOM Conference	2023
POMS Annual Conference	2023
Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics, Harvard Business School	2022
INFORMS Annual Meeting	2022
MSOM Service Management SIG Conference	2022
MSOM Supply Chain Management SIG Conference	2022
INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing (RMP) Spotlight Session	2022
ISMS Marketing Science Conference	2022
Marketplace Innovation Workshop	2022
POMS Annual Conference	2022
Cornell ORIE Young Researcher Workshop	2021

Teaching Experience

University of Washington

Building Business Applications of LLMs & Generative Models (MBA, Undergraduate)	2025–2026
Analytics for Firm Decisions (MSBA)	2026
Analytics for Marketing Decisions (MBA, Undergraduate)	2024–2025
Business Analytics Practicum	2024–2026

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Deterministic Models in Optimization (Undergraduate)	2022

Honors and Awards

First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award 2023

Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award 2023

Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Students, UIUC 2022

William A. Chittenden II Award, UIUC 2021

Finalist, Jeff McGill Student Paper Prize, INFORMS RMP Section 2020

Academic Services

Editorial Review Board, *Marketing Science*

Meritorious Service Award, *Management Science* 2024, 2025

Referee

- Journals: *Management Science*, *Operations Research*, *Journal of Marketing Research*, *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*, *Production and Operations Management*
- Conferences: NeurIPS, ACM EC, WWW, Workshop on Platform Analytics

Session Chair, INFORMS Annual Meeting 2022, 2023, 2025

Session Chair, ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2025

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